There's Just Something About Love

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There's Just Something About Love

by cabbageboy

Summary

Mother's day fic I am super late for!

It takes a lot of work to be a mom.

Join this small family as they celebrate one of their household's most important holidays

“Dowa?”

Adora wakes slowly to a small hand clenching around one of her fingers and another tugging at the bedspread that rests over her shoulders.

She lifts her head slowly, one eye open.

Finn is standing there, squinting sleepily, hair a mess of curls. Adora reaches over and taps the screen of her phone with her free hand and sees that it is just after 6 in the morning. Morgan must have said ‘goodbye’ to them this morning and they were awake with the knowledge that their mom was up and ready for the day.

“What is it?” She asks anyway, pulling her finger out of their grasp to engulf their small hand in hers. She rubs her thumb along the back of their knuckles as they yawn.

“Is mornin,” They mumble, leaning forward and placing their head on the bed next to Adora’s pillow.

She smiles.

“It sure is buddy, but how about we sleep a little longer? Don’t you want to snuggle a little bit?” She asks, lifting up the covers and gesturing under them.

Finn shakes their head.

“But is mornin. Mommy already left.”

Adora sighs.

“I know bud, she had work early today. But Cat is still sleeping. If you don’t want to snuggle we can go downstairs,” She whispers, feeling the stir in the bed of Catra rolling over and not wanting to wake her up.

“Cat seepin?” They whisper back, quieter than before. They hold their finger in front of their mouth to shush themself.

“Mhm. But we can snuggle here until she wakes up?” Adora says.

Finn nods, looking determined.

“When Cat up, is mornin.”

They crawl up into bed, Adora holding an arm out and helping them up. Clamoring over her and planting an accidental kick to her stomach and ribs along the way, Finn settles between Adora and Catra. They lean back against the plush pillows, engulfed in the comforter that Adora pulls up to their chin. She kisses them on the forehead with a smack, and it makes them giggle a little bit. Catra stirs again, and Adora and Finn both hold their breaths to see if it is finally what will wake her up, but her head rolls to the side and she snores lightly.

“K, we gotta be quiet, alright?” Adora says, resting her upper arm over her pillow and her head on her hand. The other comes up and pats Finn’s head as they hunker down further into the comforter.

“Mkay,” They say, already beginning to be soothed back to sleep by the darkness of the room and the warmth of the blankets. Two sets of blue eyes flutter closed, and they’re back to sleep quickly.

Morgan sits at the kitchen table, nervously tapping her foot on the tile floor. Her hair was still wet from the shower she’d taken when she got home from school, trying to use the hot water to sear away the nerves and anxiety causing a rampant buzzing in her head. Heart rate pounding, she’d texted Adora and Catra and asked them to talk to her at the table when they both got home from work.

This was where they had all of their serious discussions. It was where they talked about her living with them permanently instead of bouncing between foster homes like she’d done over the last

few years. It was where they talked about her past and her mom, and just how much losing her mom had affected her.

And this is where she has to sit them down and tell them that their foster daughter is pregnant.

She really had no idea how they would react.

They had been understanding with everything she'd thrown at them; the teenage anger and attitude, the late nights up crying and talking about how much she missed her mom, how much she missed the lost opportunity to have what she deemed a real childhood.

But would they be understanding about this? Because this was big.

Just as she continues talking herself into a spiral, she hears the front door open and the shuffle of shoes being kicked off and a light hearted conversation of what to have for dinner. It makes Morgan smile a little bit. Adora and Catra were just so effortlessly in tune with each other.

Adora is the first to cross the threshold into the kitchen from the entryway.

"Hey, how was your day?" She asks gently, taking in the nervous ball of a person sitting at the head of the table.

Morgan is huddled below her favorite throw blanket, the one they kept on the back of the couch for their weekly movie nights and for study sessions. The unconscious seeking out of comfort makes Adora worry instantly, and she waits for Morgan's answer as Catra comes in behind her.

"It was…" Morgan starts, but she can't seem to continue the sentence.

Her day was fucking shit, after all.

"Hey, did you want to talk now, or do you want to help us make dinner and then talk over food?" Catra asks.

Sometimes the distraction of following a recipe or instructions was soothing to her, and she'd taken up baking with Catra and helping cook dinner as a way to keep her mind off of the kinds of things that kept her up at night.

"No I… I think we need to talk now."

Catra and Adora look at each other and then quickly back to Morgan.

"Baby, I can see that you're scared, and whatever it is, we're not going to be mad at you. Ok? I can't promise a litany of other reactions, but anger is never how we are going to act toward you, alright?" Adora says.

It was an important distinction that made Morgan's shoulders relax just a little bit. Adora and Catra had been through foster care as well, and were aware of how important it was to reassure the kids the way that they needed. Morgan had a history of being treated with anger, and they suspected violence as well, and they always reassured her that there was nothing that she could do that would make them angry and act angry toward her.

But today she only half believes them.

"Ok."

Catra moves to sit at the other end of the table but Morgan pats the chair next to her.

"It's ok. I'm ok."

To Adora and Catra, that was a good sign. It meant that Morgan felt safe, that she wasn't scared of them. It meant that she was going to want comfort in the form of held hands and pats on her shoulders. It was the sign that they needed to pull out chairs on either side of her and slip into them.

It's silent for a beat while Morgan gathers her courage. Adora folds her hands on top of the table and Catra raises an eyebrow.

"Hey," Catra starts, "You look like you're about to shit yourself."

"Catra!"

But, however inappropriate it is, the cursing makes Morgan giggle, and some of the tension breaks further.

"Now, what is it you need to tell us? Lay it on me, kiddo, we're gonna be okay," Catra says, holding out a hand.

Morgan takes it.

She takes a deep breath.

And then says it.

"I'm pregnant."

Silence. Complete and total silence.

They were mad, they were angry with her and they were going to push to have her put in a different home-

"Okay."

Morgan's eyes snap up to Adora. She's sitting there calmly, both of them were. Like they had all the patience in the world. Like this wasn't a big deal.

"Okay?" She says, testing the waters. She bites her lip and shifts her eyes between the two adults at the table.

"Okay."

She really didn't know how to react. There were a chorus of voices in her head telling her she fucked up, that she did something wrong, that she wasn't coming back from this. But

here they were, telling her what she needed to hear, telling her it was okay

"You're really not mad?" She especially didn't like being lied to. If they were mad, she wanted to know.

However, Adora shakes her head.

"I'm worried, and I have awkward questions, but the last thing I am is angry at you."

Morgan looks at Catra.

She nods.

"There are things we have to talk about, but I'm not mad at you. This isn't something to be mad at you for."

And that was it.

They get up to make dinner together, Catra and Adora being a little touchier than normal, with hugs and gentle pats on Morgan's shoulders. Adora kisses the side of her head when Morgan initiates a hug. They sit down for dinner and laugh about something that happened at Adora's work that day. They talk over plans for the weekend.

Everything feels normal.

Eventually they would talk about if the sex was consensual, which it was, and if she'd gotten STI testing, which she hadn't yet. They'd take her to the doctor to make sure everything was alright. And they would talk about next steps and the direction this was going to go, whether she was going to have the baby or not and if she was going to keep them or not. They talked through all of her options and how she felt about them, and assured her that no matter what decision she made they would support her. Catra stops them at the pharmacy on the way home from the doctor and picks up the prenatal vitamins and some much needed ice cream for their movie night.

But Adora was right.

They were okay.

Everything was okay.

Catra wakes up slowly, bright sunlight filtering through the shades on the window opposite the bed. Squinting into the midmorning sunshine, she opens her eyes and turns to the side to see her wife, with Finn laying between them.

While Adora is still asleep, the movement of Catra shifting must wake Finn, and they look up at her with their bright eyes.

"Cat!" They whisper, pushing their hands above the covers and turning over to pull themself up into a sitting position on their knees.

"Hey bud," Catra murmurs back, pushing herself up to sit back against the headboard. Finn crawls up to sit on her lap and she brushes the hair out of their eyes with gentle fingers, holding their back to stabilize them on her lap.

"Dowa said, said we could get up when you woke up but now she's seepin too."

Catra bites back a giggle. Finn was just too cute, and she hadn't grown any more immune to their charm in the years she'd known them.

"Well how about we get up and go downstairs and let Dora sleep a little longer? I'll start on breakfast," Catra suggests.

Finn considers it for a moment, looking back at Adora and then to Catra.

"Pantakes?" They say timidly.

They didn’t have pancakes every morning but they always had something special on Mother’s Day.

And Finn was 100% a pancake person, just like their mom.

So the two of them head downstairs, leaving Adora up in bed to sleep a little longer.

Catra drags Finn’s stool over to the counter so they can stand on it and help her. She gets out their little kitchen knife, the plastic one they used to help cut softer fruits and veggies and grabs a carton of strawberries out of the fridge.

“Should we have sausage or bacon?” She asks, washing the strawberries in the colander and then bringing it over to the counter where Finn’s little station is.

“Bacon!” they shout, and Catra winces at the loud shriek. But Finn was excited, knowing what this morning was, and she wouldn’t squish their excitement for anything.

“Yeah?” She says, putting a few strawberries on the cutting board where Finn can start chopping them. She knows they prefer sausage with their pancakes.

“Dowa likes bacon!” They respond.

Catra smiles.

“That’s very sweet of you. Do you want me to make sausage for you too?” She asks.

“We can have both?” They gasp, dropping the plastic knife. Catra picks it up after it slides to the ground, and laughs at their reaction. It’s accompanied by a soft ‘oops’ and an even softer ‘thanks.’

“Yeah baby, if you like sausage better we can have it too. We don’t always have time to make both in the morning but it's the

weekend and a special day. And you were so sweet to think of Adora so I want to make your favorite too!" She says.

"Thank you!" They say, taking the knife from Catra and continuing to roughly chop the strawberries as well as their little hands will let them.

"You're welcome sweetheart." Catra kisses the top of their head and ruffles their hair. She starts the disney playlist low on a speaker and they work together while Finn dances carefully on their step stool.

She mixes the pancake batter and gets the griddle out of the lazy susan in the corner cabinet. Once the griddle is heating up on the counter the cast iron is set on the stove and she starts the sausage. Bacon goes in the oven once it's preheated.

"When do we see mommy?" They ask, finishing the strawberries. Catra cleans off their work surface, the cutting board, and the small knife and gets ready to let them cut their sausage into bite sized pieces for themself.

"We're going to go meet her at work and go to the restaurant by the school. The one with the little personal pizzas that you like and the nice puzzles and crayons on the kids menu," Catra responds.

"Does mommy know?"

"No baby, we kept it a surprise like you wanted."

"Did you get the flowers?"

"Of course! We have to get Mommy flowers!"

It was just so cute how excited they were about going to see their mommy, someone that they loved so much. Even though they saw each other every day Finn was getting to the age where they could really understand holidays and how important some of them were to their family. Mother's Day had barely beat out Hanukkah

and Christmas for their favorite holiday. Mostly because they adored all three of the house's mothers so much that a holiday celebrating them could beat out anything.

"And then, and then we come home?" They say in the cutest, softest little version of their voice.

They loved being home, in this place that felt so safe, so full of love. Home, the place that Catra, Adora, and Morgan had worked so hard to make their safest space, the place that they were the most comfortable. When the three of them would have died to be Finn's age again with a proper home to call their own, they worked their hardest to make sure that Finn got to have that.

"Mhm to watch a movie. But we're going to stop by the big playground near the school though, if you want to," Catra looks at them and waits for their gasp and smile.

The South River Park had been a favorite place ever since they discovered it on one of Morgan's first tours of the school, back when she was agonizing over getting into a local college so she could continue to live at home and support and stay with Finn while getting her degree. The park was by the water, with a huge playground that Finn absolutely loved.

"Oh! Yes please!" They say, bouncing on their feet on the stool. Catra puts her hand at their back to make sure they don't fall and giggles at their wide-eyed enthusiasm.

"Well I think we have to go then!"

"Can Dowa push me on the swings?" They ask.

It's then that a third voice echoes through the kitchen.

"I sure can!" Adora says, coming from around the corner off of the steps to the second floor.

"Dowa!"

Finn sets their knife down on the counter and reaches both hands up toward Adora when she gets close enough to pick them up. She hoists them high into the air over her head and spins around in a circle, earning her a slew of giggles from the child and a smile from her wife.

“Well look who's finally awake!” Catra chuckles low, coming up and kissing Adora.

Finn lets out a small “ew!” but giggles nonetheless when the attention is turned to them and they get a few kisses on the cheek from Adora and Catra.

“So, let's have breakfast and maybe watch a little TV and play while we wait for Mommy to get off work?” Adora suggests, and the three move the food toward the table and enjoy breakfast together.

It’s only when they’re in the car on the way that Finn starts fidgeting with their hands and bouncing in their seat.

“Finny baby we’re going to be there soon!” Adora turns around in the passenger seat to talk to the child in the back.

They throw their hands in the air and smile wide.

“And we see mommy?” They ask.

“Of course! And then go to lunch, and to the park! And then we’re going to watch?”

“Moana!” They shout.

“Maybe we’ll all take a nice nap before the movie!” Catra tries.

“No naps! We play!”

It makes Adora and Catra giggle that Finn had become under some sort of impression that they didn’t need a nap. But in a few

hours when they were on the way home the cranky kid was going to be practically begging to be put to bed.

“I think Adora will play with you while Mommy and I take a nap, does that sound good, bud?” Catra jokes.

Adora elbows her, but Finn seems to be along with the plan.

“Yeah!"

Adora’s eyes shoot daggers at Catra.

She wasn’t particularly a nap person, but she was a nap person when Catra was napping. Loving to snuggle up with her wife, Adora took great offense to the idea of Catra taking a nap without her.

“We’ll see how we feel when we get home, how about that?” Adora says, turning back around in her seat to face forward in the car.

They were approaching the school now, and it was looking like, if they found a good parking spot and got their things together quickly, they would be right on time to intercept Morgan on her way to her car from the library.

The room is the quietest it's been all day. The calm after labor is when she is supposed to rest, but she can’t help but wish she was at home already.

Who knew having a baby would be so tiring.

And painful.

The tearing was something she read about and was not looking forward to the possibility of. Here she was a few stitches later with a bit of a recovery ahead of her.

But she had her baby, and all was well.

There they lay in the small plastic hospital crib right next to her bed, all bundled up in the cutest little blanket. They had been a dream since the moment they came into the world fighting and crying. Their bare form had been placed on her chest and she didn't know she could feel so connected to someone so fast in her life.

But they had spent nine months together, after all. So now that she thinks about it, the connection wasn't so sudden. She'd been their mother the first time she felt them kick, the first time she felt movement and realized it was her baby.

Adora and Catra had been with her through it all.

They sat with her on the couch in the living room through the hours of labor that her contractions were further apart, did the embarrassing work of changing her sheets after her water broke in the night, and brought her to the hospital at nearly midnight to have the baby. They remembered to bring her go bag, packed with all she'd need for the days in the hospital and the trip home and kept her in good spirits as she attempted to use the bathroom by herself for the first time. They then helped her with something embarrassing that she never thought she'd need help with, and she appreciated it greatly.

It was like having parents. They were her parents this whole time, from the moment she was welcomed into her home, but never was it more evident that she was their daughter than today.

As she gave birth to her own child, they were there to encourage her and praise her with all the love she needed, all the support she longed for.

It makes her miss her mom, but her heart swells as she takes in the feeling of her moms taking care of her.

"You did so well baby," Adora had whispered, tears streaming down her face.

"We're so proud of you, kid," Catra said with an unmistakable grin.

Though the doubt is still there, the fear that she wouldn't be a good parent, that she didn't know what she was doing, starts to ebb and die within her. Because, though she'd never done this before, didn't know what she was doing, she knew one thing.

And that one thing is that she would have help, always.

They promised, and if she knew anything about Adora and Catra, it's that they kept their promises. Promises were sacred, were everything, and they would never promise her something if they didn't mean it.

Morgan sighs as she lolls her head to the side, and Catra notices for the first time that she's still awake. It was dark, the shades drawn so she could sleep this evening, but a small lamp in the corner was on and Catra had been reading while she assumed Morgan slept.

"Hey there, kid, what's going on?" Catra asks, putting her book down, taking off her reading glasses, and getting up.

"I just want to be home. I know we get released tomorrow but I just can't wait to be home with them. It feels weird, like it hasn't started yet even though they're here now."

Catra nods.

"I know what you mean. We have the staff's help and they're constantly in and out of here to check in. It doesn't feel like we're really responsible for them yet," Catra agrees, sitting in the armchair by Morgan's bed.

'We' makes her feel better, helps her settle a little more and relax. She was 100% Finn's mother, but she was young and needed help, and was more than willing for Adora and Catra to have motherly roles with them. 'It takes a village' and all that jazz.

"You're…. Still down for this right? I know it's weird, being so young and having a teenager and having them have a kid

probably isn't what you expected when you agreed to foster me but…"

"I know it's hard, but you can't let your brain take you down that road," Adora says, stepping into the room and returning from the Starbucks down the street with a chocolate croissant for Morgan, an iced tea for Catra, and a coffee for herself. She sets the drink tray and small pastry bag on the bedside table and steps up to Morgan's side, taking her hand.

"Trust me. I know what it feels like to let your brain spiral and I know that it's unstoppable at times. But you have to remind yourself that you're loved, that you're taken care of, that we'll take care of you. We're still down for this, because we told you we would be."

"I know I just… get worried. Get scared. You guys are young and I was supposed to be temporary but I ended up staying for years. And now Finn…" Morgan starts, sheepishly.

"We wanted to foster you long term, and when you got pregnant we knew that we wanted to support you in whatever you chose to do. It was our decision, and we talked through what both of those things meant for us and our relationship and how it would affect the rest of our lives," Adora says looking at Catra.

She nods.

"Don't discount that we knew what we were getting into when we made those decisions and that we made those decisions together," Catra says with finality.

Morgan nods. The fears were deep, as deep as they were when she was first put into foster care as a kid when her mom died. But the longer she spent with Catra and Adora, in a house that actually felt like a home, the more those fears dissipated.

They spent four years taking care of her, the last nine months taking care of her while she was pregnant. She had to trust that they weren't going anywhere, that she wasn't going anywhere.

Today, surrounded by the love of her foster parents and her baby, she knows she can truly believe it.

Morgan's phone starts to ring as she steps out of the library and into the sun.

"Hey babe," She says, answering the call. She pulls her curly hair to the side and over her shoulder, gentle breeze tickling her neck as she puts the phone to her ear.

"Happy Mother's Day!" Drew says, bubbly voice lighting up Morgan's smile in one swoop.

"Thank you!" She says, sitting on a bench by the entrance. "What are you up to today?"

"I have this term paper for History due at the end of the week and I need book sources for it so I was going to head to the library later today. Other than that, I woke up earlier and went to the gym. The rock wall is finally open so I got some climbing in. How about you? How was work?" He says, and she can tell that he's on his way back to his dorm by the wind in the receiver on his phone.

"Work was alright. Got all of my Calc homework done. Have you called your mom yet?"

"Nope, you're the first mom I called today. Wanted to make sure I got you before you got busy with family stuff."

He really was a sweetheart. It was all very cliche too. They met in class, never would have noticed each other in that massive lecture hall except for the project they were grouped together on. They went on a couple of dates and before she knew it, Morgan was starting to really like him.

And when he found out about Finn he was so supportive, so understanding. He didn't run, and was open to the idea of dating someone with a kid, but made sure to tell her that he needed

time and for things to go slow if they were going to work out. If this thing they had was going to go somewhere.

Ever since, they'd been taking it slow, but it was nice that he acknowledged her role as a mother and that he wasn't hiding from it like the last guy she tried to date. Ryan had all out ignored that Finn existed and it was discouraging to Morgan to date from then on.

But Drew was nothing like that, and she found herself talking about Finn a lot to him. And he seemed to like listening.

"Do you have plans? A house with three moms has to be turning up for Mother's Day."

Morgan laughs.

"Semester projects this year have me fucked up. I feel like I haven't had time for anything. We usually go out for breakfast, or we stay in and make it instead but I forgot to request off for work this morning and with finals coming up no one was taking my shift. So I really don't know if we're going to do anything special. I have a present for Adora and Catra from me and Finn but other than that I'm not sure."

She felt a little bad, not making a big deal of the holiday for her moms, but she really was swamped with school and the added shifts at work. She knew she didn't really need the money, that the parents would provide her and Finn with everything they needed, especially while she was in school, but it still felt good to add to a little savings account for herself and Finn. Plus, it was a good excuse to get out of the house without having to make plans and drain her social battery.

Today, though, she really wished she took off. Sleeping in, being woken up by a tiny knock on her door and little footsteps padding down the hall toward Adora and Catra's room. The unmistakable giggle of the child as they make their way downstairs and practically get started on breakfast themself. Either that or they

would dress themself in mismatched shoes and be ready to leave for breakfast before any of the adults get up.

"You'll pull through, I know it. You totally carried our group project that semester that my mom was in the hospital and I did basically nothing to help."

"God, what a shit show that whole semester was. How's she doing by the way?" She asks.

When his mother's heart condition acted up that semester she had been in and out of the hospital several times, and he went home to visit her frequently. She received the procedure she needed and had been doing well since, but it was a scary time for him and he ended up lacking in the schoolwork department. But Morgan was there for him and helped how she could, including doing his part of the project so he didn't fail the class and their group didn't fail the project.

He owed her a nice date after that, and had more than made up for it since.

"She's great actually. She wants to either come up and meet you or have you come down for a couple of days this summer to hang out at the house. Maybe you could bring Finn? We have a pool and there's a really nice park down the street. You two can stay in our guest room," He says.

She smiles fondly at the nervousness in his voice.

"Babe, that sounds so fun! I'm sure Finn would love to take a little trip down to your parent's place."

There was no faster way to her heart than to consider Finn and what they might need or want. The fact that Drew was constantly inquiring about them, and now was making plans and considering how they fit into those plans, was making her feel a little sentimental. Maybe it was the fact that it's Mother's Day, or maybe it's simply because she'd become emotional and mushy when she was pregnant and never quite got over *being* emotional

and mushy with her kid, but it certainly made her feel special and wanted to be dating someone that cared so much.

"Cool! Cool, yeah I am sure everyone will be excited to meet you two. And I'm really looking forward to hanging out with you and Finn."

It was more than she could have hoped for from partners in the past, and now that she had a boyfriend, however casual they were being now, that cared about her kid she couldn't imagine having someone *not* be so attentive when it came to Finn.

But just as she's about to say something else, something a little more romantic, or maybe a little spicier even, she hears the one sound that would always get her attention.

"MOMMY!"

Morgan's head whips up and turns to look to her left, between the language and math buildings where the path to the parking lot sat beneath a string of large oak trees. And right there, running toward her with Catra and Adora holding hands and following, was her little baby.

"Finny!" She says, standing from her bench and rushing forward to meet them where they jump toward her. Sinking down to the ground to hold them close, she kisses the side of their head as they giggle and squirm.

"Mommy we came to see you! Are you surprised!" Finn shouts, and she can just make out the distant chuckle on the phone in her hand.

"I am! Hold on a second baby I have to hang up the phone," She said, holding the speaker to her ear and hearing Drew's laughter.

"I take it this is my time to hang up?" They say.

"Sorry, babe, I gotta go. Finny is here! At my work!" She says, booping Finn's nose.

“Don’t apologize! It’s a nice surprise, and I’m sure you’re going to have a great afternoon with them. Tell everyone I say ‘hi’!” He says gently.

“Will do, talk to you later.”

“Later, babe.”

Once her phone is back in her pocket, Morgan drops the bag over her shoulder and picks Finn up to give them a proper ‘hello.’

There’s barely a second where Catra raises her eyebrow, smirking, and says “babe?” But Morgan ignores that in favor of giving some much needed attention to her favorite little person while Adora elbows Catra for making fun of her. After all, they were well aware that she had a boyfriend and had even met him once when they were on campus for a family event.

“Finn, hon, you remember mommy’s friend, Drew?” She says, holding them on her hip.

“Yeah! With the blue hair!”

Morgan can just hear an “ *Oh my god he has blue hair and pronouns”* that she ignores from Adora.

“That’s right! I was just on the phone with him and he wanted me to say hi to you, isn’t that cool?”

“Yeah! Dwew cool!” Finn claps.

Catra and Adora watch the interaction with wide smiles on their faces. They knew how important Finn was to Morgan and how important it was that she had a partner who cared for Finn as well. They knew the man was nervous about interacting with the kid, but he clearly was excited to prove that he wanted to be a part of Morgan’s life and all that entailed.

“Hey, you two ready for some lunch?” Adora asks, coming up and patting Morgan on the shoulder and kissing the side of her head.

“God, yes. Work dragged and I didn’t get the famous Mother’s Day breakfast today,” Morgan says, setting Finn down on the ground when they start to get wiggly in her arms and reaching out to grasp their hand.

“Well let's get to the restaurant and get this little one a pizza!” Catra says.

It’s all energy and excitement from the moment they see Morgan to the second they get in her car on the way home.

“I want to go with mommy!” They insisted, crawling up into the car seat in the back of her sedan and pulling the straps on. They waited patiently for her to buckle the harness to keep them nice and snug for the drive home, and Morgan chuckles at the droop of their eyes and the loll of their head to the side. Finn holds on as long as they can, but they give way to sleep eventually and as they pull into the driveway Morgan can’t help the smile on her face

When she gets them inside she heads to her bedroom, putting them down in bed and changing into her t-shirt and sweatpants to nap with them.

Finn feels the stir of the mattress when she crawls in but doesn’t wake up more than reaching out to tug on mommy’s shirt. She pulls them closer and counts their breaths to try to get her mind to quiet down and fall asleep. Staring at the ceiling for a while, she lets the thoughts drift as her eyes droop shut and then bat back open. Getting up early for work when the library was 24 hours was a trip. It was weird to see students on their 4th cup of coffee, clearly awake from the day before, as well as those that were just getting to the library, still half asleep.

College life was strange with a kid. There were late nights, sure, but they were never spent at the library. She wouldn’t miss tucking her kid into bed for the life of her, even going so far as to say she could only work mornings because she would never take a late shift that kept her from home, from sharing dinner, bath

time, and bed time with Finn. She can't say she'd ever have stayed at the library all night regardless, having much more comfort at home, but who could tell when a life without Finn was so far beyond what she could imagine hers now to be.

Though Finn had been unexpected, they were never unwelcome in her life. And what would be the alternative? All she really missed out on in the college experience was living on campus, which by the accounts of her friends seemed to suck quite a bit, and partying, which she was never one for anyway.

She'd gone to a high school party precisely once and walked away with a baby so… Partying wasn't really her thing.

No, she rather enjoyed the life that she had here. There was room for her and Finn to have their own space, but she still felt close to her moms and Finn felt close to them too.

The upper floor of the house is separated by the staircase in the foyer. On one end of the hall sits a full bath, separated by two bedrooms, and on the other end is the primary bedroom with its en suite bathroom. It provides a moderate amount of privacy between what had been deemed Morgan's side of the upstairs and Catra and Adora's.

Both rooms started as guest rooms for foster kids, but as Morgan went from being a short term to a long term foster, they decided to let her turn the extra guest room into her own office/sitting room. She decorated it like her bedroom, with sage greens and little twinkle lights. When she got pregnant it became the nursery, but decorated much the same. An artist friend of Catra's painted a colorful mural on the larger wall for the new baby and Adora helped Morgan set up all of the furniture they would need. They even found a rocking chair at a thrift store and had refinished it to be a crisp white to match the bassinet and the soft window shades.

It was now Finn's bedroom. Decorated with dinosaur decals on the walls, a Barbie dream house with a hot wheels track running

through it, and a large chest of dress up clothes that they used often during play time with all participating members of the house.

Morgan thinks of how proud she is of them, how proud she is of the tiny person she was raising and how proud she is of the person they were becoming. She thinks of how smart they are already, how clever and cute they are. And it's enough to help her drift to sleep with the smell of their watermelon shampoo tickling her nose with their curls.

“So,” Adora says, coming up behind Catra and wrapping her arms around her wife.

“Hmm?” Catra murmurs, leaning back and closing her eyes as she lays her head on Adora’s shoulder. She stops the scrubbing motion on the pan she was cleaning and lets her arms relax, setting the sponge and pan back in the sink and washing her hands.

“The kids should be napping for a while,” Adora whispers, running soothing hands over Catra’s shoulders and down her arms.

“Yeah?”

Catra dries her hands on a kitchen towel and then turns around in Adora’s arms to wrap her own around her wife’s waist.

“And you think you can handle me and be quiet enough for them to not wake up?” Catra teases, pushing Adora back until her hips hit the countertop opposite the sink.

“Nope. I have no faith that we wouldn’t be too loud for them to hear us and that is why I got you a present for Mother’s Day,” Adora says, pulling a piece of paper out of her pocket.

It’s a reservation confirmation for a hotel downtown, overlooking the harbor. The one that they spent their last anniversary at. The one with the jacuzzi bathtubs and the floor to ceiling windows. A nice long weekend away next month when the outdoor, rooftop

pool would be open for the summer and they could watch the sunset over the city skyline sipping drinks.

"Oh? So you're taking me somewhere expensive to have your way with me?" Catra says, sultry voice making a shiver run down Adora's back.

Adora leans down and kisses Catra, just a peck on the lips, but like always it promises more.

And she kept her promises.

"My wife deserves to be wined and dined before we-"

"Please god don't finish that sentence. You're such a dork," Catra interrupts, not interested in hearing the phrase 'wined and dined and sixty-nined' again. But Adora is *her* dork, so she lets the terrible jokes slide every now and again.

"But it's the truest thing I can think of. That you deserve for me to *take* you out and then *ea* -"

"Nope nope we can't go down this road or we're going to end up in bed with the kids banging down our door to watch a movie when they get up from their nap and Morgan is too smart not to know what we're up to when you look so guilty leaving the bedroom."

Adora scoffs.

"I do not look guilty. I hide it really well, I think you'll find."

"Babe, I'm the aloof one, remember? You couldn't hide the fact that we just had sex when Glimmer and Bow spent that one night, and you certainly can't keep it from Morgan. She has you pegged."

"You think you're any better? You couldn't hide anything from her if you tried. Your tell is that you're too aloof and she gets it immediately," Adora retorts. She starts rocking them back and

forth, dancing slowly in the empty kitchen. Her sock covered feet slide smoothly on the tile floor as she pulls back to twirl Catra, bringing her back in with her back to Adora's front.

Adora wraps her arms over Catra's, squeezing her tight.

"Thank you" She starts, taking on a more serious tone, yet it's still as gentle as she ever speaks to her wife.

"For what?" Catra sighs out, leaning her head back to once again rest on Adora's shoulder. The exposed column of her neck draws Adora's lips and she groans at the kisses up and down the length of her neck.

"For doing this with me, having this family with me. I know you were skeptical about fostering in the beginning because of our history with the system, but I just knew the second Morgan walked through the door that she was going to be someone special to us. And now we have her and Finn, and they're just… They're perfect. Everything is perfect. Our family, everything. And I wanted to thank you for doing this with me."

Adora's voice gets softer, and the emotion is palpable. Catra pulls away and turns around, placing one hand on her wife's waist and the other on her cheek.

"Baby, there's nobody I would do this with but you. You're so perfect for me, for this family we have. Thank *you* . For being patient with me. For being the rock I needed when we decided to have Morgan with us long term, the steadiness I needed when she got pregnant and I was scared of having a baby with us. You're the reason all of this is so perfect," Catra whispers, nuzzling into Adora's neck and kissing her collarbone.

"We've done good, haven't we? Morgan is happy and thriving in college and Finn is the sweetest little kid. We're doing a good job, right?" Adora looks deep into Catra's eyes and seeks the answer she needs, the one she wants.

Sometimes it was nice to be reminded that you were doing the right thing, that you were doing something good.

"We choose to do a good job every day. That's what makes this work. That we wake up every day and choose to be good parents, choose to be gentle and loving and everything that the kids need," Catra urges.

Because Adora is a good mom. Better than most of the examples they had growing up and definitely better than *her* . The insecurity, the worry that she wasn't doing a good job was one of the things that made her a good mom, though. Worrying that she's not doing what is best for the kids, examining her own behavior and striving to do better? They both took great care in making sure to deal with her own trauma in therapy and not carrying on the cycle to her kids. Those are the things that make both of them so good, that make both of them good mothers, the ones that Finn and Morgan need.

"You know you're that for them too, right? That you're so, so good at being what they need."

"When did we get so emotional and worried?" Catra asks, holding Adora around the middle and pulling her closer.

"Right around the time our baby had a baby, I think."

And Adora holds her back just as fiercely, just as strong as she always did, as she would for as long as she was able to.

Until their dying breaths. Catra and Adora had sworn it when Catra proposed, sworn it again when they married, and sworn it every moment in between. They would always be this for each other; a loving wife, a supportive partner, a gentle hand to take, a listening ear, and everything else they needed.

"Happy Mother's Day, baby."

Catra says it first, but Adora is soon to reply.

“Happy Mother’s Day.”

They go to the living room, dragging each other by the hand until Catra plops down on the recliner, pulling Adora into her lap and tucking a stray hair out of her face and behind her ear.

“So, what do you think we should get up to while the kids are napping, then?” She whispers, planting open mouth kisses along the exposed expanse of Adora’s neck.

“Hmm how about we just sit here and… enjoy each other?” Adora suggests.

“And how should we do that?” Catra says in a choked groan, nose nuzzling down into the pulse of Adora’s neck.

Adora cups Catra’s cheek and pulls her face in, kissing her cheek, her nose, her forehead, and then settling on her lips once she’s flushed and giggling.

They laugh into the kiss.

“I think we can at least make out a little bit until the kids wake up.”

Catra nods, grabbing the remote and turning on a smooth jazz channel on youtube to set the mood. Something relaxing and soothing, with the image of a fireplace and a steaming mug of coffee on the side table.

Adora sways slowly on top of Catra, back and forth with her hand still cupped to her wife’s face and her nose pressed to the temple of Catra’s head.

“You know what?” Catra says, hands roaming up and down Adora’s back and squeezing her thigh.

“What?”

“I really love you.”

“God, I really love you too.”

It goes on like that for a while, both of them dozing in and out of a nap themselves while waiting for the other two members of their household to wake up. Catra leans her face up to kiss along Adora’s cheek to her lips and they press together softly.

Everything is just so cozy; the warmth of each other, the mood of the music, the afternoon sun passing through the living room and framing a window-sized patch of light onto the floor.

It’s not too much longer before Finn and Morgan are up from their naps and ready to watch a movie.

Morgan takes her place on the couch, lounging with Finn sitting in front of her. They get a decent chunk into the movie, but at Finn’s favorite song they’re up and off of the couch.

Finn turns to their mom.

“Mommy sing it! Sing it!” Finn shouts, hopping up and down in front of Morgan until she concedes, laughing.

“Ok! Ok!” She laughs, grabbing Finn around the tummy and pulling them closer to stand between her legs. Turning them to face the TV she sings just as Moana starts to.

“ *I’ve been staring at the edge of the water, long as I can remember, never really knowing why,”* Morgan starts the song, watching Finn’s eyes light up. She sways them back and forth with the slow start of the song. When it starts to build though, Finn starts wiggling in excitement.

“ *See the line where the sky meets the sea, it calls me* ” She sings.

Adora and Catra watch from their place snuggled on the recliner together.

“ *And no one knows, how far it goes”*

She sings the song, Finn staring at the TV in delight as their mommy sings one of their favorite songs to them. Morgan keeps singing as Moana does, kissing the side of Finn's head when the song ends and holding them close in a hug.

"How was that, Finny?"

"Again! Again!" Finn says, jumping again up and down between Morgan's legs where she sits forward on the edge of the couch.

"Ok sweetheart how about we keep watching the movie and I sing the rest of the songs too?" She says.

Finn pouts.

Adora has the remote, ready to rewind to the beginning of the song.

"But mommy! That's the bestest one!" They argue.

"But my favorite hasn't come up yet. Let's watch the rest of the movie and when we get to the end I'll sing the song again," She says and Finn concedes.

"I wanna get to mommy's favorite song!"

Adora presses play on the remote and they continue watching the movie, Morgan singing all of the songs to Finn as they go along. They all laugh when she sings in a funny voice for the crab and they all try not to cry when the grandmother comes back on screen. If Catra wipes a tear from her eye no one mentions it.

Finn pays attention to the whole movie, but they climb around on the furniture and up into Catra and Adora's laps. They sit there for a while until it's time for another song and then they crawl down and walk over to dance in front of mommy. The adults pay half attention to the movie and half attention to the child, laughing and smiling as Finn giggles and dances for the music and their mommy's singing voice.

They all get up to dance to the very last song, and Morgan takes a moment to look at the way Catra and Adora interact with each other, the gentle dancing they keep up until they're interrupted by a bouncing Finn. She watches them part, reaching down to take Finn's hands, one in each of their own, and thinks that if she was going to do it all over again, she'd still go to that dumb party and still have Finn.

There was uncertainty in the future, there always would be. But Morgan knew one thing.

And that one thing is that she would have help, always.

She comes up to Adora, hugging her side, and is met with a nudge to her head from Adora's chin. Catra watches them with all the love and support she'd always had for Morgan, all the respect and determination she always saw in those eyes. And she thinks that if there was one thing she knew it was that she was loved.

She always would be.

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